

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

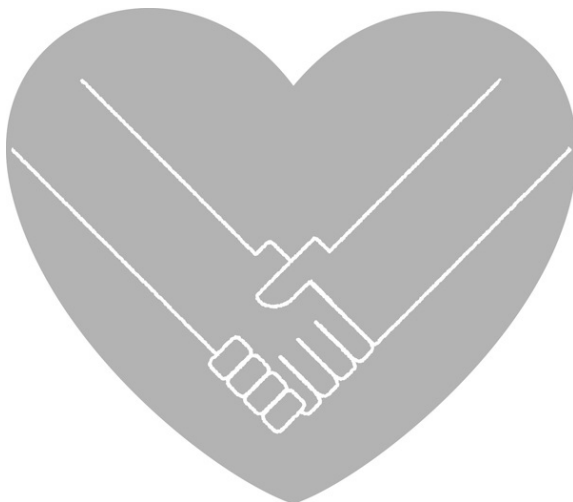
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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: That was so nice of you!



Learning Outcome

Express duty, advice, willingness, or intention to do something in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you believe in helping people you don't know?
- What are some examples of generous, selfless actions you have witnessed or done for others?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about social issues, beliefs, opinions and moral or personal dilemmas.
- I can say and use content words and function words.
- I can say and use unstressed function words.





Let's Explore!

Random acts of kindness* have a powerful effect - especially in that long **lineup**** at the airport!

* "Random acts of kindness" are unplanned, often anonymous kind actions toward another person.

** In English, "lineup" is interchangeable with the word line when waiting.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

With society becoming more individualistic, many people are starting to discover the beauty in being truly kind to those around them. Good social etiquette requires that we remain polite and respectful to everyone. Yet, we are sometimes surprised by simple actions that are out of the ordinary or completely unexpected. We may never know who initiated an action and it may be impossible to give thanks, making the gesture even more "random" or arbitrary. These actions are sometimes called "random acts of kindness" and they remind us that altruism does exist.

American author Anne Herbert is credited with first coining the term "random act of kindness" when she wrote the phrase: "practice random kindness and senseless acts of beauty" on a placemat in 1982. She later published a book entitled "Random Acts of Kindness".

Many people have their own idea of what a random act of kindness looks like. I've come up with a few suggestions:

- When you are finished reading it, leave a magazine or newspaper in a place someone else can find it. It is the perfect way to reuse something.
- Remember to be sincerely respectful of others when you are on the Internet, as you would if you were speaking to them in person. Say hello, and leave a chat with "goodbye".
- At some point in time, we've all had to call the handyman to help us out. The kitchen sink backs up, or a leaky faucet gets worse; a window needs to be reinforced or the furnace needs replacing. The next time someone is at your house fixing something, offer them a drink or a snack. Let them know you truly appreciate the work they are doing for you.
- You're in a long lineup at the airport. You're not going to miss your flight, but someone behind you in line might. Let them move ahead. Also, if waiting in the line seems to be more difficult for some people because of their age or because they are traveling with young children, let them go ahead of you. They will remember how you helped them out.





Let's Practice!

Help us find the words!

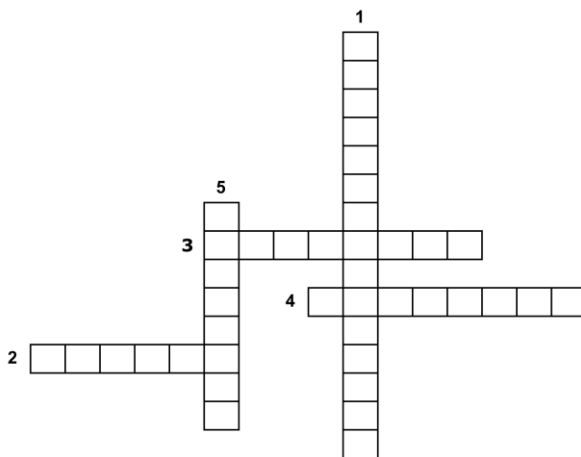
Instructions: Read the sentences. Complete the crossword.

Down

1. With society becoming more i_____, people need to be kind.
4. At some point in time, we've all had to call the h_____n to help us out.

Across

2. These actions are sometimes called "r_____m acts of kindness".
3. They remind us that a_____m does exist.
4. Someone wrote "practice random kindness and senseless acts of beauty" on a p_____t in 1982.



Let's Practice!

It's good to be kind!

Instructions: Proofread the text. Circle the misspelled words. Write the right words above the wrong ones.

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Extension Activity

Make a list of other examples of random acts of kindness.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- With a partner, discuss the idea of "random acts of kindness". Together, think of more examples.
- Go online. Do a search for other examples of random acts of kindness.
- Make a list of the 10 most interesting actions you discussed or found online.
- Write a list of these actions. For each one, write 2-3 sentences describing the action and explaining how it can help people.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I discuss the topic of kindness in my life and in the world.

☐ ☐

I read about other examples of kindness around the world.

☐ ☐

I describe 10 examples of kindness.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- individualistic** (adjective): each person thinking about themselves
e.g. With society becoming more individualistic, many people are starting to discover the beauty in being truly kind to those around them.
- random** (adjective): arbitrary; without planning
e.g. We may never know who initiated an action and it may be impossible to give thanks, making the gesture even more "random" or arbitrary.
- kindness** (noun): the state of being kind
e.g. These actions are sometimes called "random acts of kindness".
- altruism** (noun): the principle or practice of unselfish concern for others
e.g. Random acts of kindness remind us that altruism does exist.
- placemat** (noun): a small piece of material, such as paper or cloth, used to cover a table at one seat before placing dishes and utensils
e.g. American author Anne Herbert wrote the phrase: "practice random kindness and senseless acts of beauty" on a placemat in 1982.
- handyman** (noun): a person who does general repairs in the home
e.g. At some point in time, we've all had to call the handyman to help us out.





Learning Points

Content Words and Function Words

When you think about sentence stress in English, you have to distinguish between **content words** and **function words**. These two types of words have different stress in a sentence.

In a conversation, the listener subconsciously listens to the content words in a sentence, getting the main idea of what is being said.

In sentences there are **content words**, which are usually nouns, verbs, adjectives, and adverbs. These words bring images to mind. To help the listener grasp the main content of the story, you use stress and intonation with **content words** to bring attention to them.

There are also **function words**, which help structure sentences. These can be pronouns, determiners, prepositions, or auxiliary verbs. When **function words** are missing or used incorrectly, the listener can probably still get the main idea. Since **function words** don't give content, they don't need added attention or stress.

Look at the charts for a summary of **content** and **function words**. Then read the sentences from the text aloud, putting the stress on the **content words**.

Content Words

Category	Examples
noun	society, beauty, magazine, newspaper
main verb	appreciate, remember, help
adjective	polite, respectful
adverb (not adverbs of frequency)	truly, sincerely, willingly
question word	Where, When, Why
negatives	not, never





Learning Points

Function Words

Category	Examples
auxiliary verbs ("helper verbs")	am, is, could, should
prepositions	in, on, for, by
conjunctions	and, but, so
determiners	a, the, an, some
pronouns	I, he, they, we

Examples:

- With **society** becoming more individualistic, many people are starting to discover the **beauty** in being truly **kind** to those around them.
- Let them know you **appreciate** the work they are doing for you.
- They will **remember** how you **willingly helped** them out.
- Good **social** etiquette requires that we remain **polite** and **respectful** to everyone.
- Let them know you **truly** appreciate the work they are doing for you.

Personal Pronouns: Unstressed Function Words

Personal pronouns take the place of a noun or phrase. They can be the **subject** or **object** of the sentence.

Subject Pronouns	Object Pronouns	Examples
I	me	<i>I asked Alice to call me.</i>
You	you	<i>You wanted someone to give you a ride.</i>
He	him	<i>He brought a friend with him.</i>
She	her	<i>She asked Clara to email her.</i>
It	it	<i>It wanted the Zookeeper to give it some food!</i>
We	us	<i>We asked Tom to come with us.</i>
You	you	<i>Do you all have your books with you?</i>
They	them	<i>They stopped them from coming into the station.</i>





Learning Points

Personal pronouns are **function words** - they do not provide any real content. Rather, they help to structure the sentence grammatically. Therefore, you do not usually place any stress on them when you read a sentence.

For example (bolded words are stressed):

*I **like** them.*

When you pronounce the word *like*, your voice should be slightly louder and higher in pitch than when you pronounce the **function word** (*I, them*).

Depending on the what the speaker is trying to convey, it is possible to stress some **function words**.

For example:

*I like **him**, not **her**.*

In this context, the speaker wants to be very clear to the listener about who they like.

Try reading these sentences from the text aloud.

Examples:

- **We** may never know who initiated an action.
- **They** remind **us** that altruism does exist.
- **She** later published a book entitled "Random Acts of Kindness".
- **We**'ve all had to call the handyman to help **us** out.
- **They** will remember how you helped **them** out.

